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Monitoring before money: getting ready for Türkiye’s emissions trading system

The ETS Regulation published in August 2026 starts with plans, permits and verified reports. The carbon price comes later.

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Executive summary

1. Türkiye's Climate Law, Law No. 7552, was published on 9 July 2025 and created the legal basis for a national emissions trading system. The Türkiye Emissions Trading System Regulation followed in the Official Gazette No. 33353 on 27 August 2026 and entered into force the same day.
2. Installations with annual emissions above 50,000 tonnes of CO2 equivalent fall within the ETS. Smaller installations in the listed activities must still monitor, report and verify their emissions. Covered operators need an emissions permit, an approved monitoring plan and an annual verified emissions report due by 30 April.
3. The pilot phase is designed to test monitoring, reporting, verification and allocation before costs bite. That makes it the cheapest moment to get the data right, and the same data underpins the emissions figures EU buyers request under CBAM.

What has changed

The ETS Regulation replaced the 2014 regulation on monitoring greenhouse gas emissions. It sorts installations into three categories by annual emissions: up to 50,000 tonnes, from 50,000 to 500,000 tonnes, and above 500,000 tonnes of CO2 equivalent. The latter two are covered by the ETS. Activities listed in its annex include combustion, refining, iron and steel and other metals, clinker, glass, ceramics, paper and board, and a range of chemicals.

Operators need an emissions permit from the Presidency of Climate Change, valid for five years. The Regulation requires a monitoring plan to be approved at least six months before monitoring starts, and annual emissions and activity data for the previous year to be verified by an accredited body and submitted by 30 April. Records must be kept for at least ten years.

For the pilot, operators must submit their first monitoring methodology plans within two months of the Regulation's entry into force, a deadline the Presidency can extend. Allowances will be allocated under a national allocation plan, with free allocation based on benchmarks and auctions according to a published calendar. The Carbon Market Board sets the terms of the pilot and of the first implementation period.

The Regulation sets administrative fines for late verified reports and for operating without a valid permit, with higher amounts for ETS operators. Exact figures and any updates should be checked in the official text.

The decision behind the requirement

During the pilot the main cost is not carbon but data: meters, calculation methods, sampling, laboratory analyses, verification and the people who keep it all consistent. Operators who treat the pilot as a formality will meet the cost later, when allowances have a price and errors have consequences.

The same plant data serves three audiences: the Turkish ETS, EU importers asking for CBAM emissions data, and lenders and customers asking for sustainability information. A carbon price effectively paid in Türkiye may, under the CBAM rules, be taken into account when EU importers calculate what they owe, which gives well-documented domestic data a commercial value abroad.

The sound question for leadership is therefore how to build one monitoring system that is good enough for verification, reusable for CBAM and cheap enough to run every year, and who owns it.

Five common misreadings

“We are below 50,000 tonnes, so the Regulation does not apply.” Smaller installations in listed activities still have monitoring, reporting and verification duties.

“The pilot has no cost, so it can wait.” The pilot is when monitoring plans, permits and verification routines are set up. Weak foundations are expensive to fix once allowances carry a price.

“Our CBAM file and our ETS report are separate projects.” The methods differ in places, but the plant data behind them is largely the same and should come from one system.

“The verifier will fix our data.” Verifiers check data. They cannot prepare it, and errors found late delay the report.

“This is the environment team’s job.” Allowance costs and free allocation will affect margins and investment cases. Finance and leadership need to see the numbers early.

Questions for the leadership team

1. Which of our installations fall into which category, and are any close to a threshold?
2. Do we hold a valid emissions permit, or know when we must apply?
3. Is our monitoring plan approved, current and aligned with how the plant actually runs?
4. Where do fuel, material and production data come from, and how reliable are the meters?
5. Who prepares the annual report, and which accredited verifier will check it?
6. How could free allocation and allowance prices affect our margins in the first implementation period?
7. Can the same data serve our EU customers' CBAM requests?
8. Who owns carbon data in our business, and how often does leadership see it?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a monitoring readiness review for one installation: category and permit status, the monitoring plan against actual operations, data sources and gaps, and the link to any CBAM data you already supply. It should leave the leadership team with a short list of fixes and a clear owner.

Ganrich Advisory runs this as a focused review with your plant, environment and finance teams. We prepare and organise data and processes. We are not a verification body, and formal legal advice comes from qualified counsel. We share the working method in a conversation rather than in print, because it depends on the installation.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 23–24 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: Climate Law No. 7552, Official Gazette No. 32951, 9 July 2025: resmigazete.gov.tr · Türkiye Emissions Trading System Regulation, Official Gazette No. 33353, 27 August 2026: resmigazete.gov.tr · Presidency of Climate Change: iklim.gov.tr · Regulation (EU) 2023/956 establishing CBAM: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2023/956/oj

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